

Decide whether and how to invest in AI for a business opportunity; then examine the seven connected dimensions.
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

Compare the potential upside (+), constraints (-) and unknowns (?) across dimensions before choosing a strategic direction.

GO

Opportunity

Problem / people / intended value
Alternatives / priority / scope

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

1

Data

Sources & future value / Collect, acquire or label / Quality & coverage
Privacy & permitted use / Storage & access / Lifecycle & reuse

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

2

The AI team

Domain expertise / Technical skills / Communication & design
Obtain expertise / Retain & develop / Capacity & continuity

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

3

Organising AI development

Position the team / Decision authority / Portfolio & timing
Existing service or product / Build, partner or acquire / Agility & operations

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

4

Technologies

Approach & simpler baseline / Model sourcing & adaptation / Performance & explainability
Human involvement / Hosting & infrastructure / Integration & lifecycle

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

5

KPIs & value

Strategic outcome / Customer & user value / Process & people
Financial value / Model performance / Evidence & review

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

6

Risk level & benefits

Performance uncertainty / Bias, ethics & safety / Security & resilience
Strategic dependence / Benefits & acceptable risk / SWOT & portfolio fit

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

7

Culture & education

AI literacy / Roles & empowerment / Participation & ideas
Shared expertise / Continuous education / Adoption in practice

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / EVIDENCE / OPEN ISSUE

STRATEGIC DIRECTION: invest / prepare / defer / reject | conditions / owner / review date

Sources, rights and useful information
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

1.1 Sources & future value

READINESS

? Unknown

What exists internally or externally? What outcomes and corrections should we capture now for later uses?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.1

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

1.2 Collect, acquire or label

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare collection time, purchased data and expert annotation. What permissions, copyright terms and costs apply?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.1

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

1.3 Quality & coverage

READINESS

? Unknown

Do volume, variety and freshness fit the task? Which populations, periods, labels or edge cases are missing?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.1

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

1.4 Privacy & permitted use

READINESS

? Unknown

Can providers train on proprietary inputs or outputs? Check permitted recipients, training use, retention, access and exceptions.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

2021 + extension

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

1.5 Storage & access

READINESS

? Unknown

Where should data live? Consider structure, proximity, transfer speed, security, capacity and administration.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-B.3

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

1.6 Lifecycle & reuse

READINESS

? Unknown

How will sources, versions, corrections and outcomes stay linked? Set retention, deletion and recovery arrangements.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

For LLMs: trace prompts, retrieval and provider retention/training. For trained models: separate training, validation and test data.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Capabilities, sourcing and continuity
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

2.1 Domain expertise

READINESS

? Unknown

Who understands the task and recognises a plausible but wrong result? Include people affected by the workflow.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

2.2 Technical skills

READINESS

? Unknown

Which statistics, data engineering, modelling and software skills does this project actually need?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

2.3 Communication & design

READINESS

? Unknown

Who translates between specialists and decision makers? Who designs understandable outputs and interfaces?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

2.4 Obtain expertise

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare upskilling, hiring, partnerships and acquiring a team. Which capabilities must remain internally?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

2.5 Retain & develop

READINESS

? Unknown

How will people learn, share knowledge and stay? Is time for education and technical investigation funded?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-C

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

2.6 Capacity & continuity

READINESS

? Unknown

Who has time to review, maintain and support the system? Name backups and unresolved skill bottlenecks.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

For fine-tuning: name data-curation and model-evaluation skills. For agents: include integration and permission-testing expertise.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Structure, delivery and portfolio
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

3.1 Position the team

READINESS

? Unknown

Centralised, distributed or hub-and-spoke? Which arrangement enables shared expertise and access across departments?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

3.2 Decision authority

READINESS

? Unknown

Who owns budget, outcomes and access? Which people must be involved to avoid delays and unclear responsibility?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

3.3 Portfolio & timing

READINESS

? Unknown

Balance near-term improvements and longer-term exploration. Which projects share capabilities or compete for resources?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

3.4 Existing service or product

READINESS

? Unknown

Could software or AI as a service meet the need? Consider configuration, provider dependence and price changes.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

3.5 Build, partner or acquire

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare internal development, outsourcing and acquiring technology. Consider retained knowledge and maintenance.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

3.6 Agility & operations

READINESS

? Unknown

What evidence should be gathered before committing to a delivery route? Separate strategic direction from later prototypes, procurement and operation.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-D

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Keep application delivery separate from model sourcing and hosting. A system built internally can still depend on an external model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Models, people and deployment
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

4.1 Approach & simpler baseline

READINESS

? Unknown

Could rules, optimisation or ordinary software solve the task? Compare predictive, generative and hybrid approaches.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

4.2 Model sourcing & adaptation

READINESS

? Unknown

Use an existing model, adapter, fine-tuning or custom training? What task evidence, data, licences and skills justify it?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

4.3 Performance & explainability

READINESS

? Unknown

What performance and explanations must any approach provide? Which errors or uncertainties would make AI unsuitable?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

4.4 Human involvement

READINESS

? Unknown

Who labels or corrects examples? Which tasks are augmented or automated, and which judgements remain with people?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

4.5 Hosting & infrastructure

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare cloud, managed service, on-premises and edge. Include training/inference needs, capital and operating costs.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-E

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

4.6 Integration & lifecycle

READINESS

? Unknown

How do inputs and outputs connect to work? Define versioning, updates, monitoring, fallback and action boundaries.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

For LLMs: compare retrieval and adaptation. For agents: list permitted tools/actions and approvals enforced outside the model.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Outcomes, measurement and continuation
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

5.1 Strategic outcome

READINESS

? Unknown

What business outcome would make AI worth considering? Identify the current baseline and a meaningful future measure.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

5.2 Customer & user value

READINESS

? Unknown

Could value mean better service, easier decisions or a new offering? Who benefits and how will you observe it?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

5.3 Process & people

READINESS

? Unknown

Measure time, quality, rework and workload across the whole workflow. Where will released capacity be used?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

5.4 Financial value

READINESS

? Unknown

Consider revenue, margin, investment and ongoing costs. Separate staff capacity from realised cash savings.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

5.5 Model performance

READINESS

? Unknown

Which task measures and consequential errors would later determine whether an approach is adequate?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

5.6 Evidence & review

READINESS

? Unknown

What evidence would justify investing, changing direction or stopping? Who owns the later measurement?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-F

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

For generators: use task rubrics and review effort. For agents: measure completed work and action errors, not just answer quality.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Uncertainty, trade-offs and SWOT
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

6.1 Performance uncertainty

READINESS

? Unknown

What if useful accuracy cannot be reached or conditions change? Which uncertainty is decisive before investment?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.1

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

6.2 Bias, ethics & safety

READINESS

? Unknown

Who could be disadvantaged or harmed? Consider historical bias, missed errors and responsibility for consequences.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

2021 + extension

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

6.3 Security & resilience

READINESS

? Unknown

What deceptive inputs, data access or compromised components could cause harm? How will you detect and contain it?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

2021 + extension

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

6.4 Strategic dependence

READINESS

? Unknown

How exposed are we to unfamiliar technology, skill gaps, vendors, price changes or organisational dependencies?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.1

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

6.5 Benefits & acceptable risk

READINESS

? Unknown

Compare expected value with the size and reversibility of possible losses. Who can accept the remaining exposure?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.2-3

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

6.6 SWOT & portfolio fit

READINESS

? Unknown

Bring the findings together: internal strengths and weaknesses; external opportunities and threats. What changes the choice?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-G.3

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

For agents: test prompt injection, tool misuse and reach into other systems. For predictive models: test drift and adversarial inputs.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER

Participation, literacy and lasting use
STRATEGIC QUESTION / BUSINESS AREA / PARTICIPANTS / DATE

For each card, record what AI would require, its potential upside (+), its downside or gap (-), and the next strategic action.

7.1 AI literacy

READINESS

? Unknown

What should leaders, users and wider staff understand about AI capabilities, limitations and appropriate uses?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

7.2 Roles & empowerment

READINESS

? Unknown

How will work and authority change? Discuss concerns, preserve useful expertise and identify where AI supports people.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H; III-E

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

7.3 Participation & ideas

READINESS

? Unknown

How can staff help identify opportunities, shape the workflow and challenge unhelpful designs?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

7.4 Shared expertise

READINESS

? Unknown

Would a centre of excellence or lighter community help? Decide how knowledge, examples and specialists are shared.

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

7.5 Continuous education

READINESS

? Unknown

Plan ongoing learning for developers, managers and users. Who updates guidance as systems and tasks change?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Paper III-H

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

7.6 Adoption in practice

READINESS

? Unknown

What would appropriate use look like if adopted? How would the organisation notice burden, errors or avoidance?

STRATEGIC IMPLICATION / REQUIREMENTS

Added prompt

+ UPSIDE / EXISTING STRENGTH

- DOWNSIDE / GAP

NEXT STRATEGIC ACTION / OWNER

Tailor practice to the system: interpreting forecasts, checking generated content, or supervising and stopping delegated actions.

TAKE TO THE OVERVIEW: strategic implication / trade-off / dependency

PRIORITY GAP OR UNKNOWN / NEXT EVIDENCE / OWNER